WILLIAM T. SHERMAN
TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video

Thumbnail: not made yet. Owner's choice (28 Oct): wait for the vidIQ credits (refill 22 Nov 2026), then build it with tools/make_thumb.py (vidIQ battlefield = the hook scene + Sherman's real LoC photo + red brush banner).

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	Sherman-Top3-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, 738 MB)
Download	(Gofile link: see chat)
Length	15:45
Voice	Voice A: Kokoro am_michael converted to the owner's voice (reference: the approved voice-A sample)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level 0.08)
Sound effects	The channel's locked kit: Freesound recordings (CC BY / CC0), Mixkit sounds, original effects
Flags	Owner's pick A1: US 35-star flag + Confederate First National ('Stars and Bars'); never the battle flag

Chapters

Starts	Chapter
0:00	Intro: The Man Who Broke the Confederacy
2:15	Move 1: The Atlanta Campaign (May-Sep 1864)
7:01	Move 2: The March to the Sea (Nov-Dec 1864)
11:30	Move 3: The Carolinas (Feb-Apr 1865)
15:00	Legacy

Key frames: the hook (0:00-1:22)

Sherman #13 - HOOK (hook-a atlanta_hd_ref hook-1..3 incl. the south map in the same world; hook-b south_hd_ref hook-4), 0:00-1:22

Stakes (Lincoln's memorandum) -> ONE continuous zoom onto ATLANTA on the word (12.5 s), number slams 13.6 s, ATLANTA FALLS 0:27, LARGEST SURRENDER 0:38; a beat every 2-4 s. Union blue / Confederate red; US 35-star + First National.



Frame 0: theatre Aug 1864 (option 1), flags, legend; GRANT/LEE at Petersburg, 3 UNION ARMIES on ATLANTA
gun launches + impacts (shake), whoosh

AUGUST 1864 stamp (0.3 s); STALLED (Petersburg); Lincoln badge (real photo)
hit + shake x2, impacts

'expected to lose the election': Lincoln's memorandum card (verbatim, 23 Aug 1864)
pop, impacts + shake

'any hope': the paper folds shut, sealed note + paste seal; 'saving the Union': SIGNED UNREAD · BY HIS CABINET
hit; hit + shake + red pulse

'Everything now hung...': the W&A railroad glows Chattanooga -> Atlanta, gold ring on Atlanta
pop, hit

ONE continuous zoom theatre -> Atlanta, one camera; atlanta map fades in (feathered) ~5x-11x
WHOOSH (zoom #1)

Lands on 'Atlanta': atlanta map, railroads, Union corps on the siege lines (option 1)
hit + shake

BIG card slams on 'Nearly a hundred thousand' (13.6 s), ticks to 98,797; front + fort ring
hit + shake, ticks

Ticks finish; 4 MONTHS stamp on 'four months'
ticks, hit + shake

'the city still held': forts glow, guns -> impacts on the ring; STILL HOLDING
impacts + shake, hit + red pulse

'Then their general' (? badge): pull back, the army swings round the WEST side
whoosh, ref:whoosh

'its last railroad': MACON & WESTERN glows, JONESBORO ring, impacts, neckties
impacts + shake, mg, hits

2. Title and thumbnail

Title (owner's pick; not vidIQ-scored: 0 credits until 22 Nov 2026)

William T. Sherman's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Broke the Confederacy

Alternatives:

- William T. Sherman's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Marched to the Sea
- William T. Sherman's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Took Atlanta
- William T. Sherman's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Saved Lincoln's Election

Thumbnail banner texts (from the Tactical Genius results)

A: “MAKE GEORGIA HOWL”: his own words (telegram to Grant, 9 Oct 1864): defiance + menace, 3 words, no context needed (TG winners LET THEM COME 986k, “AMATEURS” 752k). **B: CUT LOOSE**: the decision of the video in plain words. Reserve: “INSANE” (the 1861 headline; insults about the general flopped twice on TG). Details: youtube/thumbnail_texts.md.

Thumbnail: not made yet. Owner's choice (28 Oct): wait for the vidIQ credits (refill 22 Nov 2026), then build it with tools/make_thumb.py (vidIQ battlefield = the hook scene + Sherman's real LoC photo + red brush banner).

When the thumbnail is made: paint out any battle flags the AI draws, redo the labels (ATLANTA, JONESBORO, SHERMAN, HOOD), infantry, guns, wagons, rails and smoke only (no tanks, aircraft or modern vehicles); the portrait is Sherman's real Brady photograph (Library of Congress, public domain), not an AI likeness.

3. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. Everything after it is the description: ready to paste, with NO links (channel rule). Keep the credit lines: the music, sound and image licences require them.

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William T. Sherman's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Broke the Confederacy

In August 1864, Abraham Lincoln expected to lose the election, and the Union with it. Everything
hung on Atlanta. Nearly a hundred thousand Union soldiers, and one general who would break the
Confederacy within a year.

In this video we break down William Tecumseh Sherman's three greatest tactical moves: the Atlanta
campaign of 1864, where he outflanked Joseph Johnston ridge after ridge and finally swung his army
around Atlanta onto its last railroad at Jonesboro; the March to the Sea, where two wings
threatened Macon and Augusta at once and the army crossed Georgia with no supply line to Savannah
and Fort McAllister; and the Carolinas campaign of 1865, through flooded swamps on corduroy roads,
past Columbia and Charleston to Bentonville and the surrender at Bennett Place. We also cover his
mistake at Kennesaw Mountain, and the cost of "hard war" for the people of Georgia and the
Carolinas.

Hit the railroad, not the wall. Threaten two places at once. Go where they say no army can.

Which was his greatest move: 1, 2 or 3? Tell us in the comments, and tell us which commander we
should cover next.

CHAPTERS
0:00 Intro: The Man Who Broke the Confederacy
1:24 Who Was William T. Sherman?
2:15 Move 1: The Atlanta Campaign (May-Sep 1864)
3:03 The Hammer and the Anvil
4:05 His Mistake at Kennesaw Mountain
5:15 The Swing Around Atlanta
7:01 Move 2: The March to the Sea (Nov-Dec 1864)
7:25 What Would You Do?
8:31 Two Wings, Two Targets
9:29 The Path of Destruction
10:13 Fort McAllister and Savannah
11:30 Move 3: The Carolinas (Feb-Apr 1865)
12:20 Roads Through the Swamps
13:14 The Trap at Bentonville
14:24 Bennett Place
15:00 Legacy

SOURCES
William T. Sherman, Memoirs of General William T. Sherman (D. Appleton, 1875)
The War of the Rebellion: Official Records of the Union and Confederate Armies, Series I, vols. 38,
39, 44 and 47
Abraham Lincoln, Memorandum Concerning His Probable Failure of Re-election, 23 August 1864 (
Collected Works, vol. VII)
National Park Service: Kennesaw Mountain National Battlefield Park
North Carolina Historic Sites: Bentonville Battlefield, Bennett Place
South Carolina Encyclopedia; Georgia Historical Society
American Battlefield Trust battle pages

CREDITS
Maps: original animations. Terrain: Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data). Rivers and state lines:
Natural Earth (public domain). Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish".
Licensed under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0.

Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots"
by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), "Distant explosions" by
Kostrava (CC0), via freesound.org. Transition sounds: Mixkit (Mixkit Sound Effects Free License).
Other sound effects: original.

Images: Library of Congress (no known restrictions; photographs by Mathew Brady's studio and George
N. Barnard). Flags: drawn from the public-domain designs.

Narration voice: AI-generated. Maps: original animations.
■ Business enquiries: [email to fill in]

#Sherman #CivilWar #MilitaryHistory
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4. Upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags	military history, civil war documentary, William T. Sherman, William Tecumseh Sherman, Sherman's March to the Sea, Atlanta Campaign, Battle of Atlanta, Kennesaw Mountain, Battle of Bentonville, Carolinas Campaign, Fort McAllister, Joseph E. Johnston, John Bell Hood, Bennett Place, animated battle map, greatest military tactics, american civil war animated history
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Language / captions	English; let YouTube auto-caption, then check the names (Tecumseh, Chattanooga, Dalton, Resaca, Oostanaula, Allatoona, Kennesaw, Chattahoochee, Jonesboro, McPherson, Schofield, Hardee, Macon, Milledgeville, Griswoldville, Ebenezer Creek, McAllister, Hazen, Salkehatchie, Bentonville, Durham's Station, Appomattox)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: the narration is an AI voice (and the thumbnail battlefield will be AI-generated). Tick the disclosure box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first chapter is 0:00)
Pinned comment	Which was Sherman's greatest move: 1, 2 or 3? And which commander should we cover next?
End screen	The George Thomas video (pitched in the last paragraph: Nashville) + subscribe, over the last ~20 s
Schedule	Your audience's peak time (YouTube Studio > Analytics > Audience)

Upload checklist

- Play the 1080p master through once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master.
- Paste title, description and tags; upload the thumbnail (1280x720) once it exists.
- Fill in the business email in the description.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'.
- Add end screen (George Thomas video) and cards; set visibility and schedule.
- After 24-48 h: check click-through rate and 30-second retention; if CTR is under 2% after ~1,000 impressions, switch to the alternative thumbnail.

Facts to double-check before publishing (approximate, single-source or second-hand; see research/FACT_NOTES*.md):
• Atlanta campaign casualties: Union 31,687 (Memoirs) vs 37,081 (Sherman's own OR table) vs ~34,500 (ABT); Confederate ~35,000. Card shows the range.
• Griswoldville Confederate losses 523 (Scaife & Bragg) vs 1,100 (ABT); Fort McAllister Union losses 92-134.
• 'No such army since the days of Julius Caesar': attributed to Johnston (book title/preface), no primary text found; said as 'is credited with saying'.
• 'War is all hell': reported from his 1880 Columbus, Ohio speech to veterans (not 1879, not wartime).
• Sent home on leave in late 1861 (Halleck); Louisiana resignation Jan 1861; Shiloh hand wound; Chattahoochee crossing 8-9 Jul; Johnston relieved 17/18 Jul; Johnston restored 22-23 Feb 1865; Raleigh 13 Apr.
• Griswoldville and Rivers' Bridge are drawn schematically (enlarged); all front lines, control areas and march routes are approximate (research/FACT_NOTES_*.md).